

PROJECT PROPOSAL

Project Title:

University Lost & Found Portal

Submitted By:

- **Zakia Nadeem** (24K-0692)
- **Simroz Sohail** (24K-0746)
- **Abeela Khan** (24K-0965)

Course Title:

Database Systems

Instructor Name:

Sir Ghulam Qadir

University:

FAST National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences

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Introduction

The University Lost & Found Portal is a web-based system designed to digitalize and streamline the process of reporting, tracking, and recovering lost items on campus. Traditional lost and found systems are often manual, inefficient, and lack proper record-keeping. This project aims to provide a centralized and automated solution for managing lost and found items within the university.

Problem Statement

In current university environments:

- Lost items are often not reported systematically

- Found items are not properly documented
- There is no centralized platform to match lost and found items
- Claim verification is weak and unreliable

This leads to inefficiency, low recovery rates, and lack of accountability.

Proposed Solution

The proposed system will:

- Allow users to report lost and found items online
- Automatically suggest matches based on item category and description
- Enable users to search and filter items
- Allow administrators to verify claims and approve handovers
- Maintain a complete digital record of all activities

Objectives

- To centralize the lost and found process
- To improve item recovery rates
- To reduce manual effort and errors
- To ensure secure and verified claim handling
- To maintain transparency and accountability

Scope of the Project

The system will be used within a university campus and will include:

- Student and staff interaction
- Admin verification system
- Database for storing item records
- Search and matching functionality

Key Features

User Features

- Registration and login
- Report lost items
- Report found items
- Search and filter items
- View suggested matches
- Submit claims

Admin Features

- View and manage all reports
- Verify and approve/reject claims
- Maintain records of item handovers

Functional Requirements

- Users must register and log in to access the system
- Users can submit lost or found item reports
- The system should suggest matches automatically
- Users can submit claims for items
- Admin can approve or reject claims
- All data must be stored securely

Non-Functional Requirements

- **Usability:** Easy-to-use interface
- **Security:** User authentication and data protection
- **Performance:** Fast processing and searching
- **Reliability:** Consistent system performance
- **Scalability:** Expandable for future use

System Modules

- User Management Module
- Lost Item Module
- Found Item Module
- Matching System
- Claim Verification Module
- Admin Dashboard

Database Overview

Main entities include:

- Users
- Items
- Reports (Lost/Found)
- Claims
- Admin Actions

Tools & Technologies

- **Frontend:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- **Backend:** Node.js / PHP / Python
- **Database:** MySQL / SQL Server
- **Development Tools:** VS Code, Git

Expected Outcomes

- Improved efficiency in handling lost and found items
- Increased chances of item recovery
- Secure and transparent claim process
- Proper digital record maintenance

Future Enhancements

- AI-based smart matching
- Mobile application version
- Notification system (Email/SMS)
- Integration with university ID cards

Conclusion

This project aims to provide a modern, efficient, and reliable solution to manage lost and found items within the university. By digitizing the process, the system will enhance user convenience, improve recovery rates, and ensure proper record management.